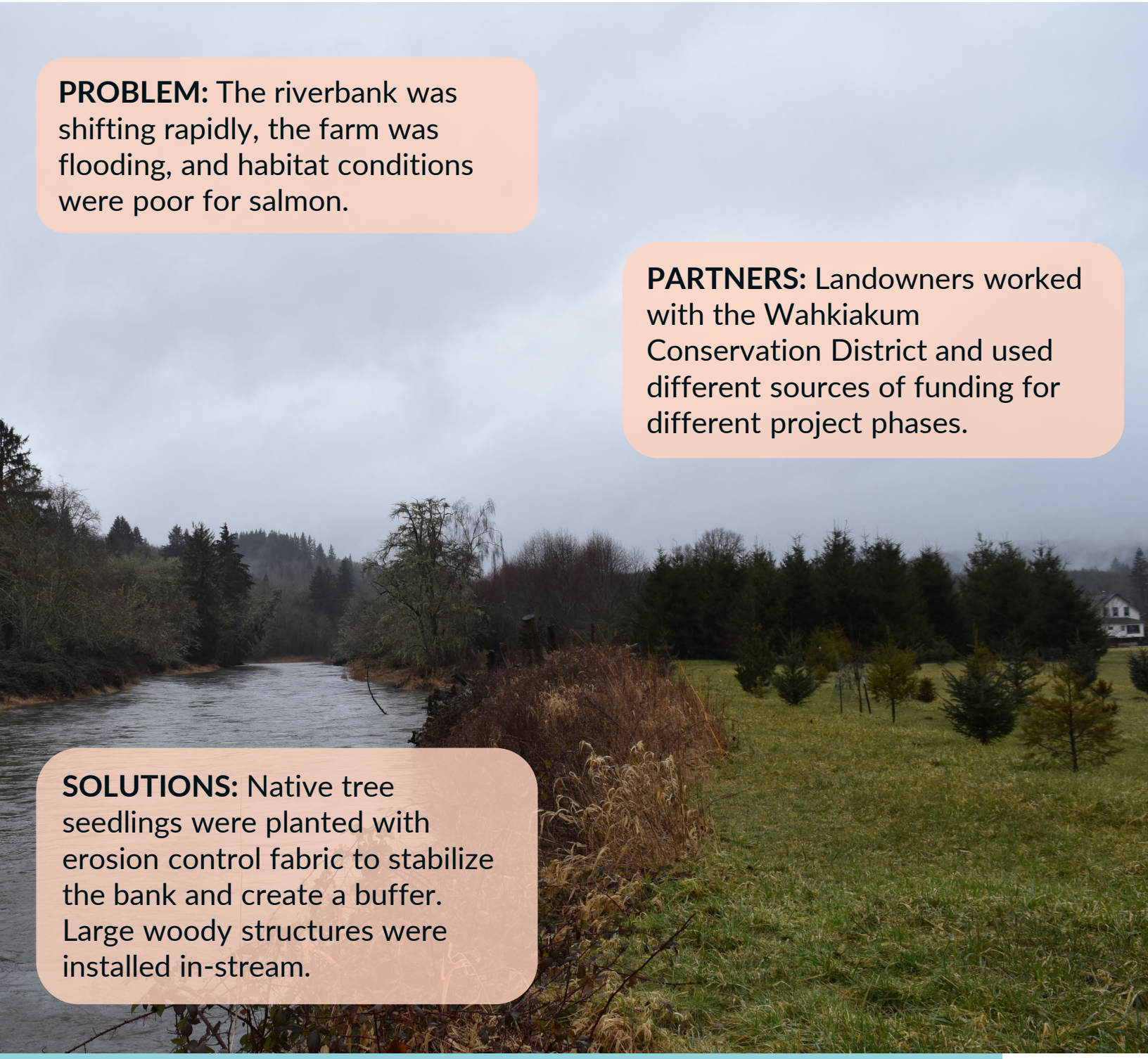
WAHKIAKUM COMMON GROUND

Success Story: Grays River

Landowners were dealing with frequent flooding, and the river channel was shifting. Using a multi-phased approach and a variety of funding opportunities, the project created a riparian buffer that reduces flooding and improves habitat for wildlife.



PROBLEM: The riverbank was shifting rapidly, the farm was flooding, and habitat conditions were poor for salmon.

PARTNERS: Landowners worked with the Wahkiakum Conservation District and used different sources of funding for different project phases.

SOLUTIONS: Native tree seedlings were planted with erosion control fabric to stabilize the bank and create a buffer. Large woody structures were installed in-stream.

Want to know more? Visit https://beav.es/WCG

Wahkiakum County MRC

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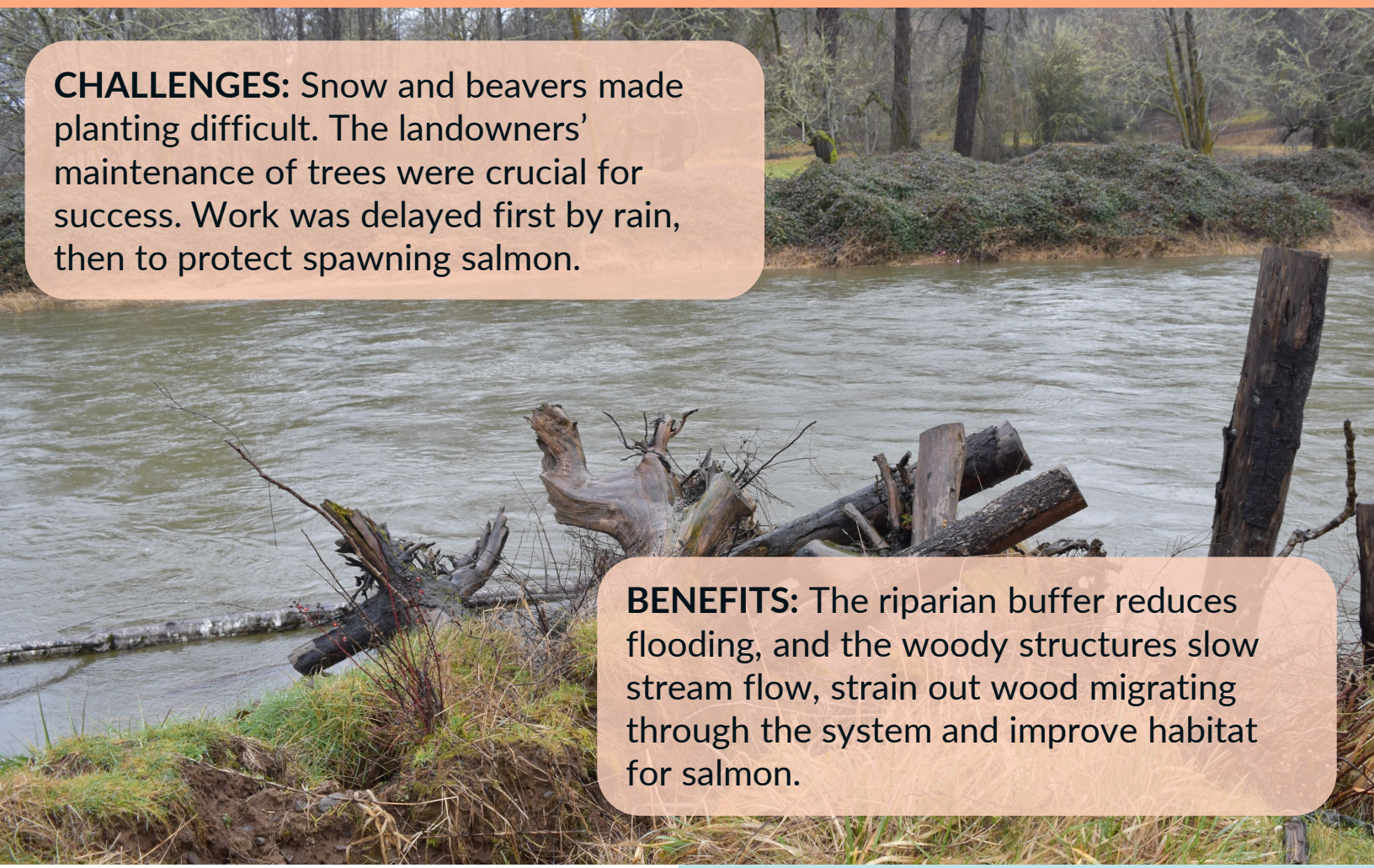

CHALLENGES: Snow and beavers made planting difficult. The landowners' maintenance of trees were crucial for success. Work was delayed first by rain, then to protect spawning salmon.

BENEFITS: The riparian buffer reduces flooding, and the woody structures slow stream flow, strain out wood migrating through the system and improve habitat for salmon.

LESSONS LEARNED

Thanks to the diligence and efforts of the landowners and project partners, trees along the streambank are now established, creating better habitat for fish, deer, and other wildlife, while also reducing flooding and erosion.

PROJECT PARTNERS & FUNDERS

Private Landowners
Wahkiakum Conservation District
Conservation Reserve Enhancement Program (USDA)
WA Salmon Recovery Funding Board (RCO)
WA Coast Restoration and Resiliency Initiative (RCO)

***Wahkiakum County** relies on a healthy salmon fishery for commercial, tribal, and recreational purposes, yet salmon populations are threatened. Efforts to support sustainable fisheries by restoring watersheds also have benefits for the community: reducing risk from coastal hazards, boosting economic vitality, and improving emergency preparedness.*

To learn about multi-benefit watershed restoration **SUCCESS STORIES** in Wahkiakum County or to **get involved** visit:

https://beav.es/WCG